

Workforce Escalation Procedure

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Purpose

This procedure describes operational escalation when workforce capacity becomes insufficient to support planned service delivery.

Indicators may include unfilled shifts, high sickness absence, critical skill shortages, excessive agency dependence or staffing levels below locally agreed safe operational requirements.

Managers should assess the affected service, identify available internal staffing options, review redeployment opportunities and escalate risks through the appropriate operational management route.

Where pressure continues, contingency actions may include authorised redeployment, additional temporary staffing, service prioritisation and senior operational review.

Workforce escalation decisions should be documented and reviewed until staffing pressure returns to an acceptable level.